

Sir George Peter Labouchere [GBE KCMG FRSA](#) (2 December 1905 in [London](#) – 14 June 1999 in [Dudmaston Hall, Shropshire](#))^[1] was a British diplomat and collector of modern art.

Career

Labouchere was educated at [Charterhouse School](#) and the [Sorbonne](#), and entered the [Diplomatic Service](#) in 1929.^{[1][2]}

He was Deputy-Commissioner for [Austria](#), 1951–53, [Minister to Hungary](#) 1953–55,^[3] [Ambassador to Belgium](#) 1955–60,^[4] and [Ambassador to Spain](#) 1960–66.^{[5][2]} He was a member of the [Society of Dilettanti](#) and was associated at various stages with the [Tate Gallery, London](#), serving as president of the Friends of the Tate.^[2] He was an avid art collector, buying, at various stages, works by British artists including [Henry Moore](#), [Barbara Hepworth](#), [Lynn Chadwick](#) and [Ben Nicholson](#). He also bought contemporary continental works, including [Victor Vasarely](#), [Antoni Tàpies](#), [Pierre Soulages](#), [Jean Dubuffet](#) and [Max Ernst](#).^[6]

Family

Labouchere was a descendant of an old [Huguenot](#) merchant family exiled in the 17th century to England, which included prominent politicians such as [Henry Labouchere, 1st Baron Taunton](#) and [Henry Du Pré Labouchere](#). His father was Lieutenant-Colonel Francis Anthony Labouchere, a banker and reserve officer, and his mother was Evelyn Stirling, only child of [Sir Walter Stirling, 3rd Baronet of Faskine](#).^[6]

His sister Lilah married [Ailwyn Fellowes, 3rd Baron de Ramsey](#), a first cousin (once removed) of [Winston Churchill](#).

Dudmaston Hall

On 10 May 1943 he married Rachel Hamilton-Russell,^[7] granddaughter of the 8th [Viscount Boyne](#). [Dudmaston Hall](#), now run by the [National Trust](#), was Rachel Hamilton-Russell's ancestral home, inherited from her maternal uncle Geoffrey Wolryche-Whitmore, and the couple settled there to restore it in their retirement.^[8] He was president of the Shropshire branch of the Council for the Protection of Rural England.^[2]

Honours

Labouchere was appointed [CMG](#) in the [1951 New Year Honours](#),^[9] knighted KCMG in 1955^[10] and given the additional, senior knighthood of GBE in the [1964 Birthday Honours](#).^{[11][2]}

References

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- ^[2] *"Sir George Labouchere".* *The Times*. No. 66566. 15 July 1999. p. 29.
- ^[3] *"No. 40032".* *The London Gazette*. 1 December 1953. p. 6533.
- ^[4] *"No. 40660".* *The London Gazette*. 20 December 1955. p. 7154.
- ^[5] *"No. 42122".* *The London Gazette*. 19 August 1960. p. 5710.

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8. "[One Lady's Legacy and Love](#)". National Trust.
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